Brightwell Analytics - Employee Handbook

Version 4.2, effective 1 March 2026. Owner: People Operations.

All names, companies and figures in this document are fictional and were written as sample data for DocQuery. Any resemblance to a real organisation is coincidental.

1. Welcome

Brightwell Analytics was founded in 2014 in Leeds and helps retailers forecast demand. We are about 180 people working across data science, engineering, sales and operations. This handbook explains how we work together and what you can expect from us. If a rule here conflicts with your employment contract, your contract wins.

2. Working hours

The standard working week is 37.5 hours. You can choose when to start and finish your day, but everyone is expected to be available during core hours, from 10:00 to 15:00 UK time, Monday to Friday. Meetings should not be scheduled outside core hours without the attendees' agreement. Overtime is not paid for salaried staff; instead, extra hours worked at a manager's request can be taken back as time off in lieu within the following two months.

3. Who to ask

Questions about pay, leave and contracts go to People Operations (people@brightwell.example). Questions about laptops, accounts and access go to the IT Service Desk (it@brightwell.example).

4. Annual leave
Full-time employees receive 25 days of paid annual leave per year, in addition to UK public holidays. Part-time employees receive the same entitlement pro rata.
After two full years of service, your entitlement increases by one day for each further full year of service, up to a maximum of 30 days per year.
You may carry over up to 5 unused days into the next leave year. Carried-over days must be taken by 31 March, after which they are lost. Leave requests are made in the HR portal and should be submitted at least two weeks in advance for absences longer than three days.

5. Sick leave
If you are ill, tell your manager before 10:00 on your first day of absence. You can self-certify sickness for up to 7 calendar days. For longer absences a fit note from a doctor is required.
Brightwell pays full salary for up to 20 working days of sickness in any rolling 12-month period; after that, statutory sick pay applies.

6. Parental leave
The primary carer of a new child receives 26 weeks of parental leave at full pay, followed by up to 13 weeks at statutory pay. The secondary carer receives 4 weeks of parental leave at full pay, which can be taken in one block or in separate weeks within the first year.

7. Remote and hybrid work
Brightwell is a hybrid company. Employees are expected in the office at least 2 days per week. Our anchor days are Tuesday and Thursday, when teams plan and meet in person.
New starters receive a one-off home office allowance of 300 GBP for a chair, desk or monitor. Receipts must be submitted as an expense claim within the first three months.

Working from abroad: you may work from another country for up to 20 working days per calendar year. Each stay needs written approval from People Operations at least four weeks before you travel, because of tax and data protection rules. Some countries are excluded for security reasons; People Operations keeps the current list.

8. Equipment
Every employee receives a company laptop. Laptops must use full-disk encryption and must not be lent to anyone, including family members. Lost or stolen equipment must be reported as a security incident (see section 12).

9. Expenses and travel

Expense claims are submitted in Ledgerly within 30 days of the expense, with a receipt.

- Meals while travelling: up to 45 GBP per day.
- Hotels: up to 160 GBP per night in London and 110 GBP per night elsewhere.
- Rail travel: standard class, unless the journey is longer than 3 hours, in which case first class may be booked.
- Using your own car: 45 pence per mile.

Flights must be booked through the travel desk and approved by your manager beforehand.

10. Learning and development

Each employee has a learning budget of 1,200 GBP per year for courses, books, certifications and conferences. Unused budget does not carry over. Requests above 500 GBP need your manager's approval. Everyone can also take 3 learning days per year, in addition to annual leave.

11. Probation, reviews and leaving

New employees have a probation period of 6 months. During probation, the notice period on either side is 1 month. After probation, the notice period is 2 months, unless your contract says otherwise. Performance reviews take place twice a year, in April and October.

12. Security incidents

Report any suspected security incident, including phishing emails, lost devices or data sent to the wrong person, to security@brightwell.example within 1 hour of noticing it. Do not try to investigate on your own and do not delete evidence. The Security team is available around the clock.

13. Raising concerns

If you have a concern about how you are treated at work, talk to your manager first. If that is not possible, contact People Operations. Concerns can also be raised anonymously through the Speak Up line, which is run by an independent provider.